INDIA'S FANTASTIC FIVE

A group of industry insiders redefine collaborative architecture, merging three practices within an 80-year-old heritage space

By **RIDHI KALE**

Photographs by NOAIDWIN STTUDIO

Historically, the design industry has always spoken of the highly regarded, solitary, brooding master architect. Then there's Alloy whose walls scream, 'great design is rarely a solo act'. Founded by five seasoned design heavyweights, Rupesh Shah, Bhavisha Thakur, Chintan Patel, Bijal Shah and Bhumika Patel, the practice represents a calculated, voluntary corporate marriage of three formidable forces: The Ink Studio Co., Limited Edition Design Studio and BT Desiign. To house this combined vision, they bypassed the predictable glamour of a glass corporate tower, choosing instead to set up shop inside an 80-year-old heritage bungalow in Mumbai that carries eight decades of visible history. For the founders, the primary challenge was never to erase that identity, but to understand it. "Rather than treating the structure as a blank canvas, we approached it as something to build upon," they note, restoring where possible and introducing new interventions only where they added value.

Technology, functionality and evolving ways of working were carefully integrated without disturbing the soul of the home. This dialogue between heritage and evolution allows the building to continue telling its story while serving an entirely new purpose. The resulting interiors feature deep oxblood walls, dark timber,

